

■ Benson’s 5 Non-Negotiables (Flashcard Sheet)

■ *Schema-first, event-driven*

Trigger phrase: Everything has a label.

Why: Keeps chaos out. Benson always knows the format.

Analogy: Like Amazon packages — every box has sender, weight, destination.

■ *Connector plug-ins*

Trigger phrase: Plug it in, don’t rebuild.

Why: Add new sources (crypto, fusion labs) without touching the core.

Analogy: Like HDMI ports on your TV. The port stays the same, you just switch inputs.

■ *Normalize before intelligence*

Trigger phrase: Clean first, think later.

Why: Raw data is messy — Benson only learns from clean, standard inputs.

Analogy: Translate everyone into English before the meeting starts.

■ *Provenance & audit*

Trigger phrase: Show your receipts.

Why: Trust = everything. If you can’t prove where data came from, it’s useless.

Analogy: Every dollar has a serial number. Every signal needs its receipt.

■ *Hybrid compute hooks*

Trigger phrase: Leave room for quantum.

Why: Don’t need it today, but we’re wired to plug into quantum when ready.

Analogy: Like running fiber internet lines before gigabit exists.

■ ADHD-Friendly Recap

■■ Labels	Ports ■	■ Clean first	■ Receipts	■ Future plug
Schema	Connectors	Normalize	Provenance	Quantum